ADVERO SOLUTIONS

HOME SERVICES LEAD CONVERSION GUIDE · 2026

THE LEAD LEAK AUDIT™

The 5 Places Your Business Loses Jobs

Where trade businesses lose work between the first enquiry and the booked job — and the exact systems that close every gap.

WHAT'S INSIDE

01 Missed or Slow Callback
The first 5 minutes determines the outcome.

02 After-Hours With No System
The window your competitors own — and you can take.

03 Quote With No Follow-Up
The silent yes that became a no.

04 Lead Called Once, Written Off
2nd and 3rd contact wins jobs you think are gone.

05 Happy Customer Never Activated
Your most valuable lead source — left unused.

THE LEAD LEAK AUDIT™

Scorecard · Cost Data · Fix Frameworks

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INTRODUCTION

You're Not Losing Jobs Because of Bad Work.

Most trade businesses that stall out share a common assumption: the problem is volume. Not enough leads. Not enough visibility. Not enough ad spend. So they pour money into marketing, tweak their Google profile, maybe run a promotion — and the results don't move the way they should.

The real problem is almost never at the top of the funnel. It's in the middle. Between the moment someone reaches out and the moment a job gets booked, there are five specific places where leads quietly disappear. Not dramatically. Not visibly. They just stop responding, move on, or never hear back at all. No one calls to tell you they booked someone else because your callback took four hours. They simply don't call back. The revenue loss is invisible — which is exactly what makes it so expensive. This audit maps each of those five leak points in detail — what causes it, what it costs, and the exact system that closes it.

~30%	5	$0
OF MONTHLY JOBS lost between enquiry and booking	**SPECIFIC LEAK POINTS** found in every trade pipeline	**ADDITIONAL AD SPEND** required to recover these jobs

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The average trade business loses 25–35% of monthly enquiries to one or more of these five gaps — without ever knowing it.
- All five gaps are process failures, not marketing failures. You don't need more leads. You need to close the ones you're already getting.
- Each leak point includes a specific, implementable fix — not a vague recommendation, but a system with defined steps.
- Businesses that close even one gap typically recover 3–6 booked jobs per month at zero additional acquisition cost.
- The self-audit scorecard at the end identifies your highest-priority gap so you know exactly where to start.

A note on the numbers: *All dollar figures are based on typical job values and conversion patterns across HVAC, plumbing, electrical, and roofing businesses. Adjust them to your own average ticket size. Even at half these estimates, the numbers are worth paying attention to.*

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LEAK POINT 01 OF 5

01

The Missed or Slow Callback

The first business to respond wins the job in roughly half of all cases.

Why Response Speed Is a Revenue Decision

Speed of response is the single most studied variable in lead conversion research — and the findings are consistent across every industry. Respond within 5 minutes and your odds of connecting are 21x higher than at 30 minutes. Respond within an hour: 7x higher than at two hours. After 24 hours, the probability of ever reaching that lead drops below 17%. In trade businesses, where most competitors call back in the late afternoon or following morning, the business that calls back in the first few minutes wins the conversation — and, disproportionately, the job.

WHAT A CLOSED PIPELINE DELIVERS

- ✓ **5-minute SLA** — every business-hours enquiry receives a personal response within 5 minutes
- ✓ **Named ownership** — first-response responsibility assigned to a specific person or rotation
- ✓ **Missed-call text-back** — fires automatically within 60 seconds, keeping the lead warm
- ✓ **Central lead log** — every incoming lead captured in one system; if it isn't logged, it doesn't exist

WITHOUT THIS — WHAT GOES WRONG

- ✗ Lead calls at 10 AM → voicemail → calls the next Google result → job booked before lunch
- ✗ 2–4 hour callback window → lead has cooled, already comparing quotes from whoever called first
- ✗ No defined SLA → response time varies from 10 minutes to 10 hours depending on who sees it
- ✗ No central log → unknown how many leads were missed, making the problem invisible

COST OF THIS LEAK

- $ First-to-call-back wins approximately 50% of all contested jobs — slow response is a coin flip you consistently lose
- $ On 20 monthly enquiries with a 2-hour average response time: 6–10 jobs lost before a conversation starts
- $ At a $1,500 average ticket: $9,000–$15,000 per month in revenue lost before anyone speaks to a customer
- $ Reputation cost: the competitor who called back first is now getting the reviews and referrals from those jobs

THE FIX: A Response SLA With Defined Ownership

- → Define a 5-minute callback SLA for all business-hours enquiries — documented, not assumed
- → Assign first-response ownership to a specific person or rotation with a clear backup protocol
- → Install missed-call text-back: automatic SMS fires within 60 seconds of any missed call

LEAK POINT 02 OF 5

02

After-Hours Enquiry With No System

The 5–9 PM window is peak consumer decision time. Most businesses are invisible in it.

Why After-Hours Is Your Most Valuable Untapped Window

Consumer research consistently shows that the highest volume of home service decisions are made between 5 PM and 9 PM — after work, when people finally have time to deal with what's been bothering them all week. Yet almost every trade business is operationally absent during this window. Phones go to voicemail. Forms go unacknowledged. The prospect waits until morning — and by then, competitors who had any kind of after-hours response have already made contact. The businesses that win after-hours enquiries aren't necessarily better at the trade — they're simply the ones who acknowledged the lead when the customer was ready to act.

WHAT A CLOSED PIPELINE DELIVERS

- ✓ **60-second auto-SMS** — fires on every after-hours missed call or form submission, every time
- ✓ **Warm, specific message** — acknowledges the enquiry, names the callback time, sets expectations
- ✓ **Priority queue** — all after-hours leads queued for morning priority follow-up, not a general inbox
- ✓ **Morning protocol** — first 30 minutes reserved for clearing the overnight queue before anything else

WITHOUT THIS — WHAT GOES WRONG

- ✕ Lead submits form at 6:30 PM → receives nothing → calls three competitors before bed → job gone by 8 AM
- ✕ After-hours calls go to generic voicemail → prospect feels ignored → calls whoever picks up
- ✕ No capture system → after-hours leads discovered the next day, if at all → 12+ hours late
- ✕ Team unaware of after-hours volume → entire category of lost revenue invisible in the numbers

COST OF THIS LEAK

- $ Conservative estimate: 25% of monthly enquiries arrive outside business hours — nearly all with near-zero conversion
- $ An auto-response system increases after-hours conversion by 40–60% in businesses that implement it correctly
- $ Recovering just 2 after-hours jobs per month at $1,500/ticket = $3,000/month from zero additional spend
- $ Compound effect: after-hours wins become reviews and referrals, creating a compounding competitive advantage

THE FIX: A 60-Second Auto-Response and Morning Priority Protocol

- → Set up automated SMS to fire within 60 seconds of any after-hours missed call or form submission
- → Message structure: acknowledge + empathise + confirm callback time + give one next action if urgent
- → Block the first 30 minutes of every business day exclusively for clearing the overnight queue

LEAK POINT 03 OF 5

03 The Quote That Left Without a Follow-Up

A sent quote is not a closed lead. It is the beginning of the conversion process.

Why Silence on a Quote Always Means Yes — to Someone Else

The follow-up failure is one of the most expensive process gaps in trade businesses — and one of the most fixable. When a quote goes out and receives no response, the default assumption is: 'They found someone cheaper' or 'They decided not to do the work.' In reality, research across B2C service industries consistently shows that 20–35% of no-response quotes are recoverable with a single follow-up contact. The customer got busy. They had a question they didn't know how to ask. They were comparing. They needed a nudge. The business that follows up gets the job. The business that waits gets silence.

WHAT A CLOSED PIPELINE DELIVERS

- ✓ **3-touch follow-up sequence** — every sent quote: call at 48 hours, message at day 5, close at day 10
- ✓ **Scripted touches** — each follow-up brief and non-pushy, focused on serving not chasing
- ✓ **CRM visibility** — open quote volume visible at all times; nothing falls out of the pipeline unnoticed
- ✓ **Conversion tracking** — quote-to-book rate tracked monthly, creating accountability and a baseline

WITHOUT THIS — WHAT GOES WRONG

- ✗ Quote sent → prospect quiet → assumed lost → no follow-up → job awarded to whoever checked in
- ✗ Follow-up relies on memory → inconsistent → most quotes never revisited after the first week
- ✗ Awkwardness about 'chasing' overrides commercial logic — revenue left on the table
- ✗ No tracking → business has no idea what quote conversion rate is, making improvement impossible

COST OF THIS LEAK

- $ 20–35% of unconverted quotes are recoverable with structured follow-up — in most businesses, zero follow-up happens
- $ On 15 quotes/month with 8 unconverted: recovering 25% = 2 extra booked jobs per month
- $ At $1,500/ticket: $3,000/month in recovered revenue from work you already visited and priced
- $ Second-order cost: every job lost on follow-up becomes a review and referral for the competitor who did follow up

THE FIX: Automated 3-Touch Follow-Up on Every Open Quote

- → Every sent quote triggers a CRM task with three follow-up dates: 48 hours, day 5, day 10
- → Touch 1 (48 hrs): Call — 'Just checking you received the quote and answering any questions'
- → Touch 2 (day 5): SMS — brief, warm: 'Happy to adjust anything if needed' | Touch 3 (day 10): Final close

LEAK POINT 04 OF 5

04 The Lead Called Once and Written Off

One unanswered call is not a closed lead. It is an unopened opportunity.

Why the Second and Third Contact Wins What the First Contact Missed

One unanswered call is not a dead lead — it's an unopened one. Sales research consistently finds that 50–80% of conversions happen after the second or third contact attempt. The prospect wasn't disinterested — they were driving, on a job site, or simply missed the call. The business that calls twice reaches them when they're available. The business that calls once donates those jobs to whoever persists.

WHAT A CLOSED PIPELINE DELIVERS

- ✓ **Minimum 3 attempts** — every lead gets at least 3 contacts across different channels before marked inactive
- ✓ **Logged sequence** — call → text → call at a different time of day; each attempt recorded with date and method
- ✓ **30-day re-queue** — inactive leads re-contacted once at 30 days with a single low-pressure message

WITHOUT THIS — WHAT GOES WRONG

- ✕ One unanswered call → voicemail left → lead written off → job awarded to whoever called twice
- ✕ No re-contact policy → outcome dependent on individual discipline → inconsistent and unreliable
- ✕ False assumption that 'if they were interested, they'd call back' — most interested prospects are simply busy

COST OF THIS LEAK

- $ 50–80% of conversions happen on contact 2 or 3 — a single-attempt policy discards more than half of recoverable leads
- $ 10% recovery rate from a structured re-contact policy on 20 monthly leads = 2 extra booked jobs per month
- $ At $1,500/ticket: $3,000/month from leads already generated — zero additional marketing cost
- $ Compounding: every uncalled-back lead potentially becomes a review and referral for the competitor who did call back

THE FIX: A Structured Re-Contact Policy With Contact Logging

- → No lead marked inactive until 3 contact attempts made — documented policy, not a guideline
- → Sequence: Call (AM) → Text (same day PM) → Call at a different time of day (day 2 or 3)
- → Re-queue inactive leads at 30 days: 'Still happy to help if the timing works' — no hard sell

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LEAK POINT 05 OF 5

05

The Happy Customer Never Activated

Every satisfied customer is an unpaid salesperson who doesn't know they're hired.

Why Word of Mouth Doesn't Happen Automatically

83% of satisfied customers are willing to refer — but only 29% actually do, because no one ever asked. Reviews work the same way: customers who had a great experience intend to leave one and then don't, because life intervenes and no one made it easy. The businesses that grow fastest on referral volume aren't doing the best work — they're the ones who built a systematic ask into every single job close.

WHAT A CLOSED PIPELINE DELIVERS

- ✓ **24-hour review request** — sent automatically after every job completion with a direct Google link
- ✓ **Scripted verbal ask** — practiced and delivered consistently at job close by every team member
- ✓ **Separate referral ask** — sent 3–5 days after review request; never combined, always two conversations

WITHOUT THIS — WHAT GOES WRONG

- ✕ Job complete → customer happy → no ask → review never written → competitor with 60 reviews outranks you with 8
- ✕ Neighbour needs the same work → customer intends to recommend you → forgets your name → competitor gets the job
- ✕ Review ask happens inconsistently — when someone remembers — so review count grows slowly and unpredictably
- ✕ Referral potential fully evaporates: every completed job is a silent zero-cost lead source never activated

COST OF THIS LEAK

- $ Businesses with 50+ Google reviews convert 30–40% more enquiries than equivalent businesses with under 20
- $ A referred customer costs $0 to acquire and converts at 3–5x the rate of a cold enquiry — highest-ROI lead available
- $ Each completed job without a referral ask = an estimated 1.2 lost future jobs — compounding over 12 months
- $ Reputation gap: every review a competitor gains while you're not asking is a permanent ranking disadvantage

THE FIX: A Systematic Review and Referral Ask at Every Job Close

- → Send a review request within 24 hours of job completion — automated, with a direct Google link
- → Script and practice the verbal ask at job close — every team member, every time, consistently
- → Send a separate referral ask 3–5 days later — never combined with the review message

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SELF-AUDIT TOOL

Your Lead Leak Scorecard

Score your business on each of the five leak points. Be honest about what is actually happening right now — not what you intend to fix. The goal is an accurate diagnostic, not a flattering one.

SCORE GUIDE	1 — **CRITICAL:** Happens consistently and costs you jobs	3 — **INCONSISTENT:** Hit or miss — depends on who's available	5 — **SOLID:** Systemised, consistent, no meaningful gaps

LEAK POINT	WHAT TO SCORE	SCORE → 1 2 3 4 5
01 Speed of Callback	How quickly does every business-hours enquiry receive a personal response?	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
02 After-Hours Response System	Do leads arriving outside business hours receive an automatic acknowledgement within 60 seconds?	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
03 Quote Follow-Up Process	Does every sent quote receive structured follow-up if not accepted within 48 hours?	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
04 Lead Re-Contact Policy	Do unclosed leads receive a minimum of 3 contact attempts before being written off?	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
05 Review & Referral System	Do you systematically request a review and referral from every completed job?	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
TOTAL SCORE		**_____ / 25**

TOTAL SCORE		_____ / 25
20–25	STRONG FOUNDATION	Your funnel is well-managed. Focus on marginal gains in your two lowest-scoring areas.
13–19	MODERATE LEAKS	1–2 areas are quietly costing you real money. Start with your lowest score immediately.
8–12	SIGNIFICANT GAPS	Multiple leak points are open simultaneously. Prioritise in order of lowest score first.
5–7	CRITICAL	The pipeline is losing leads at nearly every stage. This is the priority above all else.

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THE BENCHMARK

What a Fully Closed Lead Pipeline Looks Like

This is what the best-run trade businesses have built — not through expensive software or complex systems, but through clear processes applied consistently. Every stage below is achievable with tools that cost under $100/month. The gap between average and excellent in this industry is almost entirely a process gap, not a resource gap.

01

Every Enquiry Captured — One System

Every lead — phone, form, text, social DM — logs automatically in one place the moment it arrives. No lead exists only in someone's memory or a browser tab. Missed calls trigger instant text-backs. Forms trigger immediate notifications. The system catches everything.

02

5-Minute Response During Business Hours

A defined first-response SLA of 5 minutes exists for all business-hours enquiries. A named person or rotation is responsible. When unavailable, a backup fires. Response time is tracked. The first business to call back wins approximately 50% of all contested jobs — this is the highest-leverage metric in the pipeline.

03

60-Second Auto-Response After Hours

An automated SMS fires within 60 seconds of any after-hours missed call or form submission. It acknowledges the enquiry, names a specific callback time, and gives the prospect something to act on. By morning, they've already been contacted — they're just waiting for the full conversation.

04

Every Quote Followed Up — Three Touches

No quote is sent and forgotten. A structured follow-up sequence fires automatically: call at 48 hours, message at day 5, final check-in at day 10. Each touch is brief and non-pushy. The sequence is CRM-automated — it doesn't depend on anyone remembering. Quote-to-book conversion is tracked monthly.

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Cold Leads Re-Contacted at 30 Days

05 Leads that went quiet don't get written off — they get a single low-pressure re-contact at the 30-day mark. Simple message: 'Still happy to help if the timing works for you.' No pressure. No hard sell. This single step recovers 8–15% of leads most businesses have already written off as dead.

Review and Referral Requested at Every Job Close

06 Within 24 hours of job completion, every customer receives a thank-you message with a direct Google review link — one tap, zero friction. Three to five days later, a separate referral ask goes out. Both are scripted, trained, and consistent. Review count grows systematically. Referral pipeline compounds month over month.

NEXT STEPS

Ready to Close the Gaps?

You now know exactly where your pipeline is leaking and what it's costing you. Most trade businesses we work with discover they're losing 3–6 bookable jobs every month to processes they could fix this week — not next quarter, not after a software upgrade. This week.

If you want a second set of eyes on your specific setup — how you're handling calls, quotes, and follow-up right now — reply to this email or visit adverosolutions.com to book a 15-minute call. We'll run through your scorecard together and identify your highest-priority gap. If it makes sense to go deeper, we'll schedule a follow-up and deliver a full roadmap for your pipeline — what to fix, in what order, and exactly how — before that call ever starts.

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Ready to Find Your Biggest Leak?

Reply to this email or visit adverosolutions.com to book a 15-minute call. We'll identify your highest-priority gap together. No pitch on the first call. No pressure. Just clarity — and a clear next step.

Best,

Lorenzo

Founder, Advero Solutions

AI-Powered Lead Automation for Home Service Businesses

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